

De Ridder's fighting style is deeply rooted in his black belt expertise in Judo and Brazilian jiu-jitsu. He is renowned for his relentless grappling, consistently seeking takedowns to impose his will and hunting for submissions via rear-naked choke, arm-triangle, or guillotine.

At first glance, his style might appear unconventional.

But de Ridder effectively utilises his considerable height and reach advantage, landing powerful knees and jabs to set up grappling entries. He is considered a strategic and adaptable fighter, capable of adjusting his approach mid-fight to exploit opponents' weaknesses and control the pace of the bout.

The victory over Whittaker has firmly thrust de Ridder into the middleweight title conversation. Currently ranked No. 13 in the division, he has openly expressed his ambition to challenge for the championship and has even called for a shot at the winner of the upcoming UFC 319 middleweight title fight between Dricus du Plessis and Khamzat Chimaev.

Another notable performance came from Shara Magomedov, also known as 'Shara Bullet'. The striking specialist secured a unanimous decision victory over Marc-Andre Barriault in a bloody and aggressive bout.

With an impressive professional record of 16-1, including 12 knockouts, Magomedov's stand-up-heavy fighting style continues to captivate fans. He was reportedly hospitalised with a broken nose following the intense fight.

Can Du Plessis do it again?

Du Plessis is set to defend his middleweight title for the third time against top contender Chimaev at UFC 319 on August 17. This highly anticipated main event will pit the reigning champion against one of the sport's fastest-rising stars.

Du Plessis claimed the middleweight belt after a gruelling split-decision victory over Sean Strickland. He has since successfully defended his title twice — first



against the formidable Israel Adesanya and then in a rematch with Strickland at UFC 305 and UFC 312, respectively.

Conversely, Chimaev, also known as 'Borz', made his UFC debut in 2020 and swiftly established himself as a serious contender for the middleweight crown.

His impressive run of victories has demonstrated his diverse skill set and relentless fighting style, earning him this significant opportunity to challenge for the championship.

UFC 319 promises to be a pivotal event in the middleweight landscape, with both fighters looking to further cement their legacy. The outcome will undoubtedly have significant

Challenger alert: Dricus du Plessis (in pic) is set to defend his middleweight crown in a much-anticipated showdown against Khamzat Chimaev.

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implications for the future of the division.

Adding to the stacked main card, Brazil's Carlos Prates is also set to return against Geoff Neal. Prates recently suffered a unanimous decision loss to Ian Machado Garry in April, which snapped an impressive 11-fight winning streak. He will be looking to rebound strongly and showcase his knockout prowess against Neal.

« Du Plessis vs Chimaev will have significant implications for the future of the middleweight division »